RAPHAEL FERREIRA COELHO SANTOS

Lead Cloud Architect | AWS, Google Cloud, Azure | FinOps, Terraform, Kubernetes

São Paulo, Brazil (UTC-3, overlaps US Eastern business hours) · Open to remote work as employee, B2B contractor or through an EOR

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SUMMARY

Cloud architect with 18 years in IT, the last 9 spent on DevOps and cloud platforms in AWS, Google Cloud and Azure. I currently lead the architecture of a Cloud Center of Excellence, where we moved account provisioning to AWS Control Tower and Account Factory for Terraform and brought the wait for a ready-to-use account **down from 22 days to 2**. Before that I worked for IT consultancies in banking, insurance and energy, doing pre-sales architecture, migrations and FinOps. One of those engagements fixed a backup cost problem that saved an insurance client **$100K a month**. I still write Terraform every week and I am usually the one called in for critical EKS and GKE cases.

SKILLS

AWS: Control Tower, Account Factory for Terraform, Organizations with SCPs and RCPs, IAM Identity Center, VPC, Transit Gateway, Route 53, EventBridge, Lambda, EKS, Bedrock, Textract, QuickSight

Google Cloud, Azure, OCI: GKE, Cloud Run, Shared VPC and landing zones on Google Cloud; AKS and Azure DevOps; migrations to OCI

Architecture and FinOps: C4 diagrams, pre-sales and business cases, cloud migrations, landing zones and guardrails, cost governance and anomaly detection

Delivery: Terraform, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Azure Pipelines, Jenkins, Argo CD, Helm, canary releases

Platforms: Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, AKS, OpenShift), Docker, Istio, Prometheus, Linux, Python, Bash

EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Architect | Druid — Mar 2025 – Present

Remote · Cloud Center of Excellence (CCoE)

- Rebuilt the Cloud Center of Excellence so product teams can move on their own while the company keeps control of security, cost and network rules.
- Replaced a manual account request process, with little cost visibility and a lot of hand-made network changes, with **AWS Control Tower and Account Factory for Terraform**. New production and test accounts now come with the guardrails already in place, and onboarding went **from 22 days to 2**.
- Wrote the standards that let AWS and Azure run under one governance model, covering landing zones, network and security guardrails, and how the two clouds connect.
- Helped set up the FinOps practice and built QuickSight dashboards with anomaly detection that alert on business KPIs.
- Still hands-on: I write Terraform modules and pipelines with the teams and step in on critical EKS and GKE cases.

DevOps Engineer (freelance) | FIS — Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Remote · freelance contract in parallel with the Druid role

- Terraform for AWS and EKS workloads, Azure Pipelines with canary releases, and FinOps habits for the DevOps team.

Lead Cloud Architect | TIVIT — Jan 2024 – Mar 2025

IT consultancy · client engagements · Remote

- Ran pre-sales architecture for cloud deals, from requirement workshops with clients to C4 diagrams, cost estimates and the business cases presented to the executive board.
- Traced an AWS Backup cost anomaly at an insurance client and redesigned the SCP guardrails around it. Savings reached **$100K a month, a $700K breakeven in 7 months**.
- Designed and delivered an OCR solution on Amazon Textract and Amazon Bedrock that reads contract data at scale. I also coordinated the new automation team and mentored junior architects.
- Planned migrations from on-premises to AWS, GCP and OCI, starting with service discovery to avoid surprises in cost and cutover, and built the Terraform modules and pipelines to run them.

Lead Cloud Architect | Engineering Brasil — Jul 2022 – Dec 2023

IT consultancy · client engagements

- Led pre-sales architecture across Google Cloud, AWS and Azure, including cost and business case estimates for new deals.

- Defined shared standards for security, networking and IaC across the three clouds, plus the connectivity model between them.
- Designed Kubernetes microservice platforms and CI/CD in GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps and Jenkins, and set up FinOps practices and KPIs for enterprise clients.

Senior Software Engineer | Itaú Unibanco — Apr 2022 – Jul 2022

Consulting engagement

- Worked on Camada Zero, the program that moved core services from a monolith to microservices on Kubernetes, building pipelines for monoliths, microservices, serverless and IaC.
- Connected GitLab CI to Jira so that moving a card triggered the delivery automation, and took care of cluster administration and application images.

Cloud Architect | Grupo FCamara — Aug 2020 – Apr 2022

IT consultancy · client engagements

- Wrote Terraform modules for Azure, GKE and AWS for a digital bank, deployed OpenShift and set up Azure Pipelines with canary releases.
- Delivered the Open Finance infrastructure as code for three large Brazilian banks, with microservices on EKS and AKS.
- Reorganized the company's own AWS accounts and led FinOps and governance work. Reusable modules took environment delivery **from weeks to minutes**, with disaster recovery at the lowest cost we could get.

DevOps Engineer | BBCE (Brazilian energy exchange) — Mar 2020 – Aug 2020

Consulting engagement

- Terraform on AWS and EKS for the company's microservices, Azure Pipelines with canary deployments, and the first IaC and FinOps standards for the DevOps team.

Earlier experience

- **2017 to 2020, DevOps Engineer** at Mandic Cloud Solutions, Pitang and ViViTech (consulting engagements). Rebuilt manual infrastructure as Terraform on AWS, moved on-premises applications to AWS and monoliths to Kubernetes, and ran GitLab CI and Jenkins pipelines with SonarQube and canary releases.
- **2008 to 2017, infrastructure, network and Linux roles.** IT technician in the Military Police (network maintenance and Linux administration), communications sergeant in the Brazilian Army, data center network analyst, and IT specialist working with Puppet, Ansible, Chef and Cisco.

OPEN SOURCE AND WRITING

automacao_terraform on GitHub: 77 reusable Terraform modules for AWS, Google Cloud and Azure, each with tests, examples, a diagram and CI, plus a patient documents reference app running active-active on AWS and Google Cloud. Architecture write-ups with diagrams and cost notes at raphaelfcs.github.io/portfolio.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate, Amazon Web Services (2023)
- FinOps Certified Engineer (2025), FinOps Certified Practitioner (2024), Introduction to FinOps and Introduction to FOCUS (2024), FinOps Foundation
- LFS162 Introduction to DevOps and Site Reliability Engineering (2025) and LFS142 Introduction to Backstage (2024), The Linux Foundation
- Introduction to Generative AI, Large Language Models and Responsible AI (2024) and Google Cloud Essentials (2023), Google Cloud
- GitLab Certified Git Associate; AWS Educate Getting Started with Networking (2025); Uncomplicating Kubernetes and Istio, LINUXtips
- Cloud Computing Solutions Architect and Cloud Computing DevOps Engineer, FIAP (2022); English Certificate C2, International English Test (2024)

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

Technology Leadership, CTO/CIO Program, FIAP, 2025 – Present
Associate Degree (Tecnólogo) in Cloud Computing, FIAP, 2020 – 2022
Computer Science, UniFieo, 2008 – 2013
Portuguese (native) · **English** (professional working proficiency)